

FOLKLORE HORRORS

FOLKLORE HORRORS IS A MONSTER SUPPLEMENT FOR 5E THAT PRESENTS LEGENDARY CREATURES DRAWN FROM GLOBAL folklore as encounter-scale apex threats rather than minor curiosities or regional spirits. Instead of adapting these figures into low-level nuisances or simple reskins of existing monsters, this book treats them as powerful supernatural forces capable of shaping entire encounters and dominating the environments they inhabit.

The intent of this product is to create standalone folklore bosses that feel mythic without inflating the underlying math of the system. Each creature functions as a complete encounter built around legendary actions, lair actions, and distinct behavioral identities. These monsters do not appear as wandering animals or random encounters. They are singular horrors—things villages whisper about, things sailors refuse to name, things that shape the geography and fear of a region.

Cultural stories, legends, and historical interpretations are intentionally kept minimal. Many of these creatures exist in dozens of regional variations, and folklore rarely provides a single definitive version. This supplement focuses on encounter design rather than narrative authority. Use these stat blocks as tools. Whether these horrors are ancient spirits, fiends, fey, forgotten gods, or something stranger is left to the GM.

FOLKLORE HORRORS ROSTER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Nuckelavee	12	Skinless horse-demon of northern seas whose blight poisons land, water, and air.
Manananggal	10	Winged night predator that separates its body to hunt sleeping victims.
Black Annis	11	Iron-clawed hag who drags prey into her cave and devours them alive.
Asanbosam	9	Tree-dwelling vampire with hooked feet that ambushes travelers from the canopy.
Ljirag	8	Shapeshifting tundra spirit that lures wanderers away to become hopelessly lost.
Tikbalang	9	Tall horse-headed trickster that twists forest paths and confuses travelers.
Boo Hag	10	Skin-stealing witch that infiltrates settlements before revealing its true form.
Adaro	10	Storm-born ocean spirit that hurls lightning and hunts along reef and coast.
Tiyanak	8	Demonic infant that lures victims with cries before transforming into a savage predator.
Camazotz	13	Bat demon of ancient temples whose sonic shriek can shatter entire warbands.
Grootslang	13	Ancient serpent-elephant hybrid guarding treasure in deep caverns.
Nian	12	Horned beast of legend that descends on villages in terrifying seasonal rampages.
Nalusa Falaya	10	Shadow-thin forest spirit that spreads dread and drains courage from travelers.

MANANANGGAL



MANANANGGAL

Large fiend (folklore horror), chaotic evil

Armor Class 17 (natural armor)

Hit Points 168 (16d10 + 80)

Speed 30 ft., fly 60 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
20 (+5)	18 (+4)	20 (+5)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	18 (+4)

Saving Throws Dex +8, Con +9, Wis +7

Skills Perception +7, Stealth +8

Damage Resistances cold, lightning, bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Damage Immunities poison

Condition Immunities poisoned, charmed

Senses darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 17

Languages Common, Abyssal

Challenge 10 (5,900 XP)

Regeneration. The manananggal regains 15 hit points at the start of its turn if its lower body still exists and the torso is not in sunlight. If the lower half is covered in salt, garlic, or radiant damage is dealt to it, this regeneration stops until the end of the manananggal's next turn.

Night Predator. While in darkness, the manananggal has advantage on attack rolls against creatures that have not yet taken a turn in combat.

Legendary Resistance (3/Day). When this monster fails a saving throw, it can choose to succeed instead.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The manananggal makes two Claw attacks and one Proboscis attack.

Claw. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +9 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 14 (2d8 + 5) slashing damage.

Proboscis. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +9 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 18 (3d8 + 5) necrotic damage, and the manananggal regains hit points equal to half the damage dealt.

Shriek of the Night (Recharge 5–6). The manananggal emits a terrifying shriek. Creatures of its choice within 30 feet must succeed on a DC 17 Wisdom saving throw or become frightened for 1 minute. A frightened creature may repeat the save at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on a success.

BONUS ACTIONS

Split Body. At dusk or when combat begins, this fiend may separate its upper torso from its lower half as a bonus action. The flying torso gains a fly speed of 60 ft. but the lower body remains motionless at a location chosen by the creature. If the lower half is destroyed (AC 14, 60 hit points), the manananggal dies instantly.

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

The manananggal can take 3 legendary actions, choosing from the options below. Only one legendary action option can be used at a time and only at the end of another creature's turn. The manananggal regains spent legendary actions at the start of its turn.

Claw Attack (1 Action). The manananggal makes one Claw attack.

Wing Dash (1 Action). The manananggal flies up to half its flying speed without provoking opportunity attacks.

Drain Blood (2 Actions). The manananggal makes a Proboscis attack.

LAIR ACTIONS

When fighting near its hidden lower body or within its hunting territory, the manananggal can take lair actions. On initiative count 20 (losing initiative ties), it takes one of the following actions:

Swarm of Bats. Bats fill a 30-foot radius. The area becomes heavily obscured until the next round.

Predator's Darkness. Magical darkness spreads in a 20-foot radius centered on a point the manananggal can see. The darkness lasts until the next round.

Blood Scent. The manananggal senses injured creatures. Until the next round, it has advantage on attack rolls against creatures that have taken damage.

- This fiend hides its lower half in a concealed location before attacking.
- It hunts at night and uses darkness and flight to isolate prey.
- Destroying or discovering the hidden lower body becomes the central objective of the encounter.

BLACK ANNIS



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BLACK ANNIS

Large fey (folklore horror), chaotic evil

Armor Class 18 (natural armor)

Hit Points 195 (17d10 + 102)

Speed 40 ft., climb 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
22 (+6)	14 (+2)	22 (+6)	13 (+1)	16 (+3)	18 (+4)

Saving Throws Str +10, Con +10, Wis +7

Skills Perception +7, Stealth +6, Intimidation +8

Damage Resistances cold, necrotic; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Condition Immunities frightened

Senses darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 18

Languages Common, Sylvan

Challenge 11 (7,200 XP)

Bogey Terror. Creatures that start their turn within 30 feet of this fey must succeed on a DC 17 Wisdom saving throw or become frightened until the start of their next turn.

Rend Doors and Stone. Structures offer little resistance to this creature. Its attacks deal double damage to objects and structures.

Legendary Resistance (3/Day). When this monster fails a saving throw, it can choose to succeed instead.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. This fey makes three Claw attacks.

Claw. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +10 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 18 (2d10 + 6) slashing damage.

Seize Prey. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +10 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 16 (2d8 + 6) bludgeoning damage, and the target is grappled (escape DC 17). Until this grapple ends, the target is restrained.

Devouring Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +10 to hit, reach 5 ft., one grappled creature. *Hit:* 27 (4d10 + 6) piercing damage, and this fey regains hit points equal to the damage dealt.

BONUS ACTIONS

Tree Meld. While touching a tree that is Large or larger, this fey can magically step inside it and emerge from another tree within 60 feet as a bonus action.

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

This fey can take 3 legendary actions, choosing from the options below. Only one legendary action option can be used at a time and only at the end of another creature's turn. This fey regains spent legendary actions at the start of its turn.

Claw Attack (1 Action). This fey makes one Claw attack.

Savage Leap (1 Action). This fey jumps up to 30 feet to an unoccupied space it can see without provoking opportunity attacks.

Drag Into Darkness (2 Actions). This fey moves up to half its speed while dragging a grappled creature.

LAIR ACTIONS

When fighting within its forest territory or near its hidden den, this fey can invoke the dread of the woods. On initiative count 20 (losing initiative ties), it takes one of the following actions:

Living Roots. Roots erupt from the ground in a 20-foot radius. Creatures in the area must succeed on a DC 17 Strength saving throw or become restrained until the next round.

Falling Branches. A tree limb crashes down at a point this fey can see within 60 feet. Creatures in a 10-foot radius must succeed on a DC 17 Dexterity saving throw or take 18 (4d8) bludgeoning damage and fall prone.

Dark Forest. The forest canopy thickens unnaturally. A 30-foot radius becomes heavily obscured until initiative count 20 of the next round.

- This fey hunts from the forest canopy and prefers to ambush isolated targets.
- It uses Tree Meld constantly to reposition and keep prey inside dense forest terrain.
- It grabs a victim, retreats into the woods, and devours them away from the group.

IJIRAQ



IJIRAQ

Medium Fey (folklore horror), chaotic neutral

Armor Class 17 (natural armor)

Hit Points 144 (17d8 + 68)

Speed 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	20 (+5)	18 (+4)	16 (+3)	18 (+4)	18 (+4)

Saving Throws Dex +8, Wis +7, Cha +7

Skills Deception +7, Perception +7, Stealth +7, Survival +7

Damage Resistances cold; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Condition Immunities charmed

Senses darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 17

Languages Common, Sylvan, Inuit

Challenge 8 (3,900 XP)

Perfect Mimicry. This Fey can magically assume the appearance and voice of any humanoid it has seen. Creatures must succeed on a DC 16 Wisdom (Insight) check to realize the deception.

Lost Path. Creatures within 30 feet of this Fey have disadvantage on Wisdom (Survival) checks to track or navigate.

Snowstride. Difficult terrain caused by snow or ice does not cost this Fey extra movement.

Legendary Resistance (3/Day). When this monster fails a saving throw, it can choose to succeed instead.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. This Fey makes two Claw attacks.

Claw. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +9 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 14 (2d8 + 5) slashing damage plus 9 (2d8) cold damage.

Shattering Mirage (Recharge 5–6). Illusions fracture reality in a 30-foot radius centered on this Fey. Creatures of its choice must succeed on a DC 16 Wisdom saving throw or become disoriented until the end of their next turn. While disoriented, a creature must move up to half its speed in a random direction at the start of its turn and has disadvantage on attack rolls.

BONUS ACTIONS

Slip Through Snow. This Fey becomes invisible until the start of its next turn if it is standing in snow, fog, or heavy precipitation.

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

This Fey can take 3 legendary actions, choosing from the options below. Only one legendary action option can be used at a time and only at the end of another creature's turn. This Fey regains spent legendary actions at the start of its turn.

Claw Attack (1 Action). This Fey makes one Claw attack.

Illusory Double (1 Action). This Fey creates a duplicate illusion of itself that lasts until the start of its next turn. Attack rolls against this Fey have disadvantage until then.

Lead Astray (2 Actions). One creature this Fey can see within 60 feet must succeed on a DC 16 Wisdom saving throw or move up to half its speed in a direction chosen by the Fey.

LAIR ACTIONS

When fighting in arctic wilderness or blizzard conditions, this Fey can invoke the spirits of the tundra. On initiative count 20 (losing initiative ties), it takes one of the following actions:

Blinding Snow. A 20-foot radius becomes heavily obscured by swirling snow until the next round.

Treacherous Ice. Ice spreads across the ground in a 20-foot radius. Creatures must succeed on a DC 16 Dexterity saving throw or fall prone.

Echoing Voices. Illusory voices fill the air. Creatures within 30 feet must succeed on a DC 16 Wisdom saving throw or have disadvantage on attack rolls until the end of their next turn.

- This Fey isolates prey rather than fighting directly.
- It uses illusions and forced movement to split the party in snowstorms.
- It retreats and stalks the group rather than remaining in open combat.

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